Men's Bible Study: Spiritual Leadership

Luke Johnston's selected teaching, writing or development sample; original bylines and citations retained.

Full teaching files

burden and courage (final) *2 pages*

Character and Integrity pdf *2 pages*

man of the word *2 pages*

prayer and dependence on God *2 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

GUYS BIBLE STUDY: LEADERSHIP KEYS FROM EZRA & NEHEMIAH

1) A Man with A Burden for God's People:

a) Spiritual leaders must carry a deep burden for the well-being of God's people

b) Nehemiah's concern for Jerusalem's physical and spiritual state drove him to action (Nehemiah 1:4; 2:17-20)

c) Ezra similarly showed a burden for the people's spiritual condition (Ezra 9:5-15).

i) Questions to consider

(1) When I see spiritual needs around me, do I respond with prayer and a burden like Nehemiah and Ezra, or am I indifferent? How can I grow in my sensitivity to the needs of God's people/work?

(2) In what areas of my life am I being called to take action because of a burden God has placed on my heart?

(3) How often do I bring the needs of others before God in prayer, as Nehemiah did?

2) A Man of Courage and Determination:

a) Nehemiah confronted adversaries with unwavering resolve, and he ensured the completion of the wall despite threats (Nehemiah 4:7-23; 6:1-14)

b) Ezra displayed courage in addressing the people's sins and guiding them through difficult decisions to restore righteousness (Ezra 9:5-15; 10:1-17).

i) Questions to consider

(1) When faced with opposition or discouragement, do I remain firm in following God's call, like Nehemiah, or do I become easily discouraged?

(2) Am I willing to confront sin and lead people back to righteousness as Ezra did, even when it is very uncomfortable?

(3) In what areas of leadership is God calling me to greater boldness?

(4) How do I respond when the work of God faces external threats or internal challenges? Am I determined to keep building and moving forward?

_____

_____



GUYS BIBLE STUDY:

7 LEADERSHIP KEYS FROM EZRA & NEHEMIAH

I. <u>A Man of Character and Integrity:</u>

a. A spiritual leader must exhibit godly character and integrity, serving as a model for others. This includes being above reproach, self-controlled, respectable, and blameless (**1 Timothy 3:2-7; Titus 1:6-9**)

b. Nehemiah showed integrity by focusing on God's glory rather than personal gain, refraining from exploiting his position (**Nehemiah 2:17; 5:14-19**)

c. Ezra also showed integrity by challenging the people to align with God's standards, motivated by a desire to honor God (**Ezra 7:10; 9:1-4**)

II. <u>A Man of Servanthood</u>

a. Spiritual leaders are called to serve others, following the example of Jesus (**Mark 10:42-45; John 13:1-17**)

b. Nehemiah displays servanthood in the entire book. His whole mindset was service, right on the front lines with everyone else. He delegated jobs and did jobs himself as well.

c. Ezra displayed servanthood by leading the people in worship and repentance (**Ezra 9:5-15**).

d. Another key to this is bearing burdens of the weak. Bearing the burden of the less mature is a STAPLE of leaders and more mature disciples (**Rom. 14:1; 15:1-3; Gal. 6:1-2**)

III. <u>A Man of Humility</u>

a. A large part of <u>humility</u> as a leader is getting/taking counsel and delegating

   i. Nehemiah- **Nehemiah 2:11-18; Neh. 8:1-8** (Ezra is reading and leading the people in a great revival and preaching chapter)

   ii. Ezra- **Ezra 9:1; Ezra 5: 1-3; Haggai 1:1-13** (the leadership in Ezra takes the counsel of God's prophets Haggai and Zechariah)

   iii. Hezekiah- **2 Chron. 32:1-3; 2 Kings 19:1-7; Isa. 37:1-7**

   iv. David- **2 Samuel 19:1-8; 2 Samuel 12:1-14**

v. Countless Biblical Examples: Josiah (**2 Kings 22:11-20**), Jehoshaphat (**2 Chron. 18:4-7**), Joash (**2 Kings 12:1-2**), Esther (**Esther 4:12-16**), Rehoboam (**12:6-8**; good advice vs bad advice), etc.

IV. <u>A Man of the Word of God:</u>

a. A deep knowledge of God's Word is essential for spiritual leaders, guiding them in making wise decisions (**James 1:5; Proverbs 4:7; 1 Kings 3:9**)

b. Ezra was known for his dedication to studying, practicing, and teaching God's Word, which provided the foundation for his leadership (**Ezra 7:6, 10; Neh. 8**)

c. Nehemiah also relied on God's wisdom, as seen in his strategic actions during the rebuilding process (**Nehemiah 1:8**)

d. This is also seen in Jesus great teaching on Leadership and Fruitfulness in discipleship (**John 15**)

V. <u>A Man of Prayer and Dependence on God:</u>

a. A consistent prayer life and complete reliance on God are foundational to spiritual leadership

b. Nehemiah exemplified this by constantly turning to God in prayer for guidance, protection, and strength in the face of opposition (**Nehemiah 1:4-11; 2:4; 4:9; 6:9, 14; 13:14, 22**)

c. Ezra also led the people in prayer and fasting, emphasizing dependence on God for protection during their journey (**Ezra 8:21-23**; **9:5; 10:1)**

d. The Bible shows all over the place the importance of continuous prayer and <u>complete</u> reliance on God in leadership (**2 Chron. 16:7-9; 20:12-17; Judges 7:2-7; John 15**)

VI. <u>A Man with A Burden for God's People:</u>

a. Spiritual leaders must carry a deep burden for the well-being of God's people

b. Nehemiah's concern for Jerusalem's physical and spiritual state drove him to action (**Nehemiah 1:4; 2:17-20**)

c. Ezra similarly showed a burden for the people's spiritual condition (**Ezra 9:5-15**).

VII. <u>A Man of Courage and Determination:</u>

a. Nehemiah confronted adversaries with unwavering resolve, ensuring the completion of the wall despite threats (**Nehemiah 4:7-23; 6:1-14**)

b. Ezra displayed courage in addressing the people's sins and guiding them through difficult decisions to restore righteousness (**Ezra 9:5-15; 10:1-17**).

GUYS BIBLE STUDY: LEADERSHIP KEYS FROM EZRA & NEHEMIAH

1) **<u>A Man of the Word of God:</u>**
   a) A deep knowledge of God's Word is essential for spiritual leaders, guiding them in making wise decisions (**James 1:5; Proverbs 4:7; 1 Kings 3:9**)
   b) Ezra was known for his dedication to studying, practicing, and teaching God's Word, which provided the foundation for his leadership (**Ezra 7:6, 10; Neh. 8**)
   c) Nehemiah also relied on God's wisdom, as seen in his quoting and knowledge of the Law (**Nehemiah 1:8**)
   d) The key to their relationship to the word of God, was that they loved it and they showed this through their obedience to it (**1 Cor. 8:1**)
      i) To not allow ourselves to be "puffed up" we must use the knowledge we have and obey the word of God. A great place to use this effectively for God is in a leadership role.
2) **Questions to Consider**
   a) How often do I turn to God's Word for guidance in my daily decisions? Do I rely on it consistently, or only in moments of uncertainty or need?
   b) When I study Scripture, am I intentional about applying it to my life and actions, as Ezra did? How can I ensure that I am not just a hearer but also a doer of the Word?
   c) Do I find joy and delight in reading and obeying God's Word, or do I approach it as a task or obligation? How can I grow in my love for Scripture? Am I modeling a love for God's Word and a reliance on prayer to those I lead? (**1 Cor. 8:3**)
   d) In what ways does my knowledge of God's Word influence **my leadership**? Am I leading with humility and obedience, or do I sometimes let knowledge "puff me up"?
   e) Do I intentionally make time to teach or share God's Word with others, as Ezra did? What steps can I take to grow in my ability to encourage others with Scripture?

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

GUYS BIBLE STUDY: LEADERSHIP KEYS FROM EZRA & NEHEMIAH

GUYS BIBLE STUDY: LEADERSHIP KEYS FROM EZRA & NEHEMIAH

1. A Man of Prayer and Dependence on God:

i. A consistent prayer life and complete reliance on God are foundational to spiritual leadership

ii. Nehemiah exemplified this by constantly turning to God in prayer for guidance, protection, and strength in the face of opposition (Nehemiah 1:4-11; 2:4; 4:9; 6:9, 14; 13:14, 22)

iii. Ezra also led the people in prayer and fasting, emphasizing dependence on God for protection during their journey (Ezra 8:21-23; 9:5; 10:1)

iv. The Bible shows all over the place the importance of continuous prayer and complete reliance on God in leadership (2 Chron. 16:7-9; 20:12-17; Judges 7:2-7; John 15)

1) Questions to Consider

i) How regular is your prayer life? Do you find yourself turning to God only in times of need, or do you maintain a consistent dialogue with Him?

ii) When faced with decisions, do you first seek God's direction through prayer? Can you recall instances where this led to clarity or peace?

iii) In challenging situations, how often do you rely on prayer for strength and protection? Have you experienced moments where prayer provided you with the strength you needed?

iv) Do you trust God to meet your needs, both big and small? Are there areas in your life where you struggle to rely on Him fully?

v) Reflecting on Nehemiah and Ezra's dedication to prayer, how can you emulate their commitment in your own life? What steps can you take to deepen your reliance on God through prayer?

vi) If you hold a leadership role, how does your prayer life influence your leadership style? Do you seek God's wisdom and guidance in your decisions, and how does this affect those you lead?

vii) Beyond formal prayer times, how do you maintain a spirit of prayer throughout your day? Are there practices you can adopt to "pray without ceasing"?

viii) When prayers seem unanswered, how do you respond? Do you maintain trust in God's timing and sovereignty, or do you struggle with doubt and impatience?

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

GUYS BIBLE STUDY: LEADERSHIP KEYS FROM EZRA & NEHEMIAH